

Chicago Tribune



\$4.00 | SATURDAY, AUGUST 15, 2026 | CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump asks justices to OK ballroom

Appeals court ruled construction needed approval of Congress

By Ann E. Marimow
THE NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration on Friday asked the Supreme Court to approve the construction of President Donald Trump's White House ballroom to replace the demolished East Wing. The planned 90,000-square-foot

ballroom has been mired in litigation since the president tore down the East Wing in October as part of his plan to dramatically remake the White House campus. But the courts have let Trump build even while questioning the project's legality, allowing the ballroom to steadily rise.

The administration's request for intervention from the nation's highest court comes after an appeals court said on Aug. 7 that the president had most likely exceeded his authority by moving ahead with the

privately financed project without approval from Congress. The case poses a test of the limits of executive authority for a Supreme Court that has embraced some, but not all, of the president's agenda. It also presents the justices with yet another challenge to one of Trump's signature initiatives.

D. John Sauer, the solicitor general, told the justices on Friday that the project was already 65% complete and suggested it was too late to stop construction. A 250-person crew has been work-

ing 20 hours a day, seven days a week to build a concrete-and-steel superstructure that now stretches five stories deep and 70 feet high, he said.

"Halting the project will stall this vital construction, making this president — the subject of recurrent assassination attempts — much less safe, and risking future presidents' safety," he wrote in the Friday filing.

In its 2-1 ruling, the U.S. Court of Appeals for the District of Columbia Circuit said the Constitution gives Congress — not the president

— the responsibility to decide when proposed changes to the White House may move ahead.

"Congress has not ceded unfettered authority to the executive branch to dramatically redesign, reshape and reconstruct the White House — the People's House — to fit a particular president's desires," the appeals court ruled.

The appeals court had paused its ruling for two weeks to give Trump time to appeal to the Supreme

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Conviction in Midway Blitz case reduced

Man pleads guilty to misdemeanor following scrutiny of grand jury

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A felony conviction secured by federal prosecutors stemming from a traffic altercation during Operation Midway Blitz has now been reduced to a misdemeanor after renewed scrutiny by the U.S. attorney's office's handling of grand jury matters called his plea deal into question.

Anthony Gonzalez Alvarez, 27, of Lyons, was originally indicted in October on the same day — and by the same federal grand jury — involved in the now-dismissed "Broadview Six" case. In fact, the indictment was the first to be secured after U.S. Attorney Andrew Boutros made an unusual appearance before the panel to talk about their duty to be fair, including in immigration cases.

Alvarez ultimately pleaded guilty in April to a separate felony charge

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Finding the future in a time capsule

Project aimed at violence prevention and intervention

By Tess Kenny
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Earlier this year, Thomas Givens couldn't answer the question of what he envisioned for his future. The 26-year-old had been involved in West Side street life for more than a decade and a half, had seen and felt the consequences of gun violence time and time again.

So that age-old ask of who he wanted to be when he grew up wasn't something Givens had really considered before.

Lately, though, he's been giving more thought to the idea. A year out, to start.

A pair of Chicago organizations have teamed up to help those most vulnerable to street violence prioritize a positive path forward by giving them a chance to create their own personal time capsules. The

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Air and Water Show dry/wet run

Above: A Chicago Fire Department helicopter and boat practice maneuvers Friday in Lake Michigan near Oak Street Beach ahead of the Chicago Air and Water Show. The events run from 10:30 a.m. to 3 p.m. today and Sunday.

Right: A military jet steaks over Lake Michigan on Friday in preparation for the Air and Water Show. The scheduled lineup includes demonstrations by the U.S. Air Force Thunderbirds, U.S. Army Golden Knights parachute team and a variety of other civilian and military aircraft.

ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS



Fuel prices push some to reconsider options



Chris Dever at the Damen Avenue Pink Line station on Wednesday. Dever was a full-time Lyft driver until he was priced out due to rising fuel prices. He opts to take public transit more since ending his time with Lyft in the spring. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Drivers look to save by mixing in more public transit, bicycles

By Evgenia Anastasakos
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Forty hours a week used to be enough for Christopher Dever, 42, to make a living as a Lyft driver. But as the cost of a full tank of gas crept up from \$60 to \$80, he found himself living in what he calls "a cycle of scarcity," working 60-hour weeks to scrape by.

Although Lyft offered a temporary fuel relief program for eligible drivers, it wasn't enough to offset Dever's costs, and he increasingly found himself paying high prices out of pocket. On his drives, he planned trips to the suburbs or northwest Indiana to

save money on gas.

Still, there was often little left of his paycheck after paying his bills. "Just that little bit extra that I was paying at the pump was having an impact on my entire life," Dever said. "I'm working all these hours, I'm making all this money for this company, yet it's all going back into just being able to operate my vehicle."

Gas prices have surged since late February at the start of the war in Iran. Following a brief reprieve in June and July, gas prices in Illinois are climbing once again and Chicago drivers are feeling it. After bottoming out at a multimonth low of \$3.89 in early July, the average cost for a gallon of gas rebounded to \$4.28 this week, according to the U.S. Energy Information Administration.

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Severe storms snarl ISU move-in

The university is cleaning up after severe storms on Thursday left thousands without power and delayed residence hall move-ins. **Chicagoland, Page A3**

Mangione pleads guilty to stalking

Luigi Mangione pleaded guilty on Friday to federal stalking charges in the killing of UnitedHealthcare CEO Brian Thompson. **Nation & World, B4**

Cubs beat Cards in pitchers' duel

Team hitting its stride during dog days of summer with a 72-51 record after 3-0 win over the rival Cardinals at Wrigley Field on Friday. **Sports**

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